

Political Science M.A.

Application Information

Application period: 15 February – 31 March (winter term)

Semester start: October 1st (winter term)

Language(s) of instruction: English

Introduction

The Master's program in Political Science at the University of Hamburg is research-oriented and focuses on international relations, comparative politics, and their reflection in political theory. Students will deepen the fundamental knowledge and skills in political science that they acquired in a bachelor's program. This will enable them to critically evaluate political science theories, methods, and research findings. Students also develop competence in independent, research-driven analytical academic work.

The two main thematic areas are Global Challenges, Governance, and Transformation and Political Decision Making and Political Processes. Topics include global health, climate change, international organizations, conflict, migration, political behavior and decision-making, democratic institutions, autocratic rule, political economy, and theories of justice, democracy, and statehood.

The program prepares students for challenging, research-oriented careers as political scientists in academia, politics, public administration, the media, business, and civil society at the national and international levels.

For more information, please see: <https://www.wiso.uni-hamburg.de/studienbuero-sozialwissenschaften/studiengaenge/ma-political-science.html>

Admission Requirements

Applicants must meet the following requirements to be considered for the selection procedure to the MA Political Science at the University of Hamburg.

a) University degree

Applicants must hold a first university degree (B.A. or equivalent) with at least 80 ECTS in the field of social sciences.

Students may apply even if their degree is not yet completed, provided they submit their degree certificate by the end of the first semester of the master's program (31 March at the

latest).

- b) Sufficient knowledge of English, demonstrated by one of the following tests at the specified level:
- Revised TOEFL Paper-delivered Test: at least 22 points per skill (Reading, Listening, Writing)
 - TOEFL Internet-based Test (test date scores): 92 points with at least 22 points per skill (Listening, Writing, Speaking, Reading)
 - International English Language Testing System (IELTS) – Academic: Overall Band Score of at least 6.5 (Good Competent User) with at least 6.0 per skill
 - Cambridge English Qualification C1 Advanced
 - Cambridge English Qualification C2 Proficiency
 - Cambridge English Qualification C1 Business Higher

Furthermore, the following qualifications may be accepted:

- A university entrance qualification obtained at an English-speaking institution or in a state with English as an official language
- A university degree in an English-language degree program
- Five years of English language instruction at a school in the European Union or European Free Trade Association

Degree certificates and transcripts of records must be submitted in German or English. Please submit your original documents plus certified translations if original documents are not issued in German or English.

Applicants who do not document that they meet all of the entry requirements are not considered for admission.

Applications and documents submitted after the deadline will not be considered!

Recognition of transcripts for degree programs completed at foreign higher education institutions

If you obtained your first degree abroad, your certificate will be reviewed during the application procedure in the faculty of your program.

If your degree certificate is not in English or German, please include a copy of a certified English or German translation of the certificate with your application documents.

Application

Online Application

You will need to complete the online application available on University of Hamburg's application portal during the application period: www.uni-hamburg.de/online-application. Please create a user account, enter your information online, upload the required documents to your online application and submit your application online.

The application procedure for the master program is an online procedure. This means that you do not need to submit any documents in paper form or via email to Universität Hamburg. Instead,

you have to upload the documents. Selection is based on the information you provide online and the documents you upload.

If you want to submit an additional special application (e.g. hardship application), you will need to send this special application separately via the online application portal together with the required proofs as an upload by the application deadline. For more information on special applications, please see www.uni-hamburg.de/sonderantrag and www.uni-hamburg.de/info-master.

Documents to submit

The following documents must or should be uploaded as part of the online application:

1. A two-page-maximum, English-language written statement of motivation explaining your choice of studies (mandatory). Please address the following questions in your statement:
 - a) Why do you want to study the Master's degree program in Political Science at the University of Hamburg?
 - b) Which area of political science are you primarily interested in? Please briefly explain this interest.
 - c) What political science-related knowledge and experience do you possess (e.g., internships, publications, thesis, work as a student assistant, tutoring, project work, or other activities)?
 - d) What specific knowledge of empirical social research methods do you have? How did you acquire this knowledge?
 - e) What do you expect from the program in terms of your personal and professional future?
2. Certificate of your first university degree.
If you are still studying when you apply and cannot yet provide a final certificate containing your final grade, please submit your current Transcript of Records confirming your provisional grade point average. You will then need to submit your degree certificate by the end of the first semester of the master's program (31 March).
3. Transcript of Records showing your current grade point average (GPA) (mandatory).
The transcript must include the titles of the modules and courses you have completed, your examination results and credit points earned, and your current GPA.
If you have not yet completed your studies, your transcript must be issued during the current term or semester.
If your transcript does not show your current GPA, the examination office/administrative body of your degree program must calculate and confirm it. Please attach this confirmation to your transcript.
4. Official explanation of the grading system (mandatory)
Applicants with university degrees from outside Germany must submit proof of their GPA and an official explanation of the grading system. Check your degree certificate or current

Transcript of Records to see if the grading scale of your first degree is available there. If the grading scale is unclear on these documents, please submit additional, official proof of the grading scale for your first degree. This explanation must show the minimum passing grade and the highest possible grade.

You may also submit a Vorprüfungsdocumentation for your degree (e.g., from Uni-assist) if you have obtained one for another application.

For applicants from China, India, or Vietnam, submitting a certificate from the Akademische Prüfstelle is highly recommended.

5. Proof of English language skills (mandatory).

Please submit one of the following documents:

- Revised TOEFL Paper-delivered Test: at least 22 points per skill (Reading, Listening, Writing)
- TOEFL Internet-based Test (test date scores): 92 points with at least 22 points per skill (Listening, Writing, Speaking, Reading)
- International English Language Testing System (IELTS) – Academic: Overall Band Score of at least 6.5 (Good Competent User) with at least 6.0 per skill
- Cambridge English Qualification C1 Advanced
- Cambridge English Qualification C2 Proficiency
- Cambridge English Qualification C1 Business Higher
- University entrance qualification obtained at an English-speaking institution or in a state with English as an official language
- Proof of a university degree in an English-language degree program (if the language of instruction is not indicated on the degree certificate or diploma supplement, please submit a written confirmation from the university)
- A certificate proving five years of English language instruction at a school in the European Union or European Free Trade Association

Applicants who, at the time of their application, are not able to prove their English language skills as listed above, must provide a proof of their registration for the next possible test date (e.g. print out of the online registration). In this case, the test result must be submitted for enrollment (not later)!

6. Aptitude test.

If you have taken any of the following aptitude tests, please submit your test results:

- Graduate Record Examination (GRE) General Test
- Graduate Management Admission Test (GMAT) 10th Edition
- Graduate Management Admission Test (GMAT) Focus Edition

This will improve your chances in the selection process.

7. Documents supporting your statement of motivation.

It is recommended that you submit relevant documents, such as certificates or work references, to support the claims you made in your statement of motivation.

8. Curriculum vitae (mandatory).

All documents must be submitted in German or English. Please submit your original documents plus certified translations if original documents are not issued in German or English.

Selection criteria

If the number of applicants exceeds the number of available places, applicants will be selected according to a ranking based on the following criteria:

- a) GPA of your first university degree (40 %)
- b) statement of motivation (30 %)
- c) GRE oder GMAT score (30 %)

For details of the legal basis for this regulation, please see the Bylaws Regarding the Selection Procedure and Criteria for the Degree Programs in the Faculty of Business, Economics and Social Sciences: www.uni-hamburg.de/campuscenter/studienorganisation/ordnungen-satzungen/auswahlsatzungen/auswahlsatzungen/wiso.html [German]

Admission and enrollment

Once your application has been reviewed, an acceptance or rejection letter will be made available in your STiNE account under the Dokumente (Documents) tab. Please see the information at www.uni-hamburg.de/online-application. An enrollment deadline will be indicated in your acceptance letter - please submit the documents required for enrollment by this date. The enrollment process is an online process. Detailed information about the enrollment process is provided at www.uni-hamburg.de/masterenrollment.

For questions regarding application requirements and the application process, please check the FAQ of MA Political Science: <https://www.wiso.de/studienbuero-sozialwissenschaften/stichwortverzeichnis/political-science-faq>

Contact

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